Saturday, October 14

Yesterday's poll has evidently disappeared from the news. But Netanyahu is finished. Nonetheless, according to official news reports, spokespeople from the Likud and representatives of Netanyahu's family are active in the information center in Tel Aviv. One more scandal.

It seems that the army's entry into northern Gaza is now just a matter of hours away. It demanded that inhabitants of the northern part of the enclave evacuate by 4:00 p.m. local time. Two local hospitals refused—they have nowhere to go. In the meantime, Hezbollah and Iran remain on the sidelines; the numerous incidents along the northern border and rockets fired from Lebanon are almost exclusively coming from the Hamas and Islamic Jihad units located there, with Hezbollah's authorization, of course.

US support of Israel, made abundantly clear by the carrier group off the country's shores, is probably the main deterrent that keeps Hezbollah at bay, since Israel has lost much of its own power of deterrence as a result of the catastrophically successful Hamas attack. This enormous psychological loss will remain a major issue for Israel for a long time to come. After 1967, the country emanated an aura of invincibility that contributed to its defense—and also to its delusions. It started to get shaky with the Yom Kippur War, and even more so after the Second Lebanon War. It all came crashing down on October 7.

Based on documents found on the bodies of slain Hamas terrorists, it is becoming evident that the kidnapping of civilians, including children, was always part of their plan: the terrorists entered with detailed maps of the kibbutzim closest to the border. As for the slaughter that took place, the responsibility lies with Hamas and with the rabble that entered Israel in the wake of the first incursion to engage in looting and killing. The motivations may have been different, but the slogan was the same: "Slaughter the Jews." The official number of Israelis killed on October 7 is now set at 1,400; the number of hostages at 220.